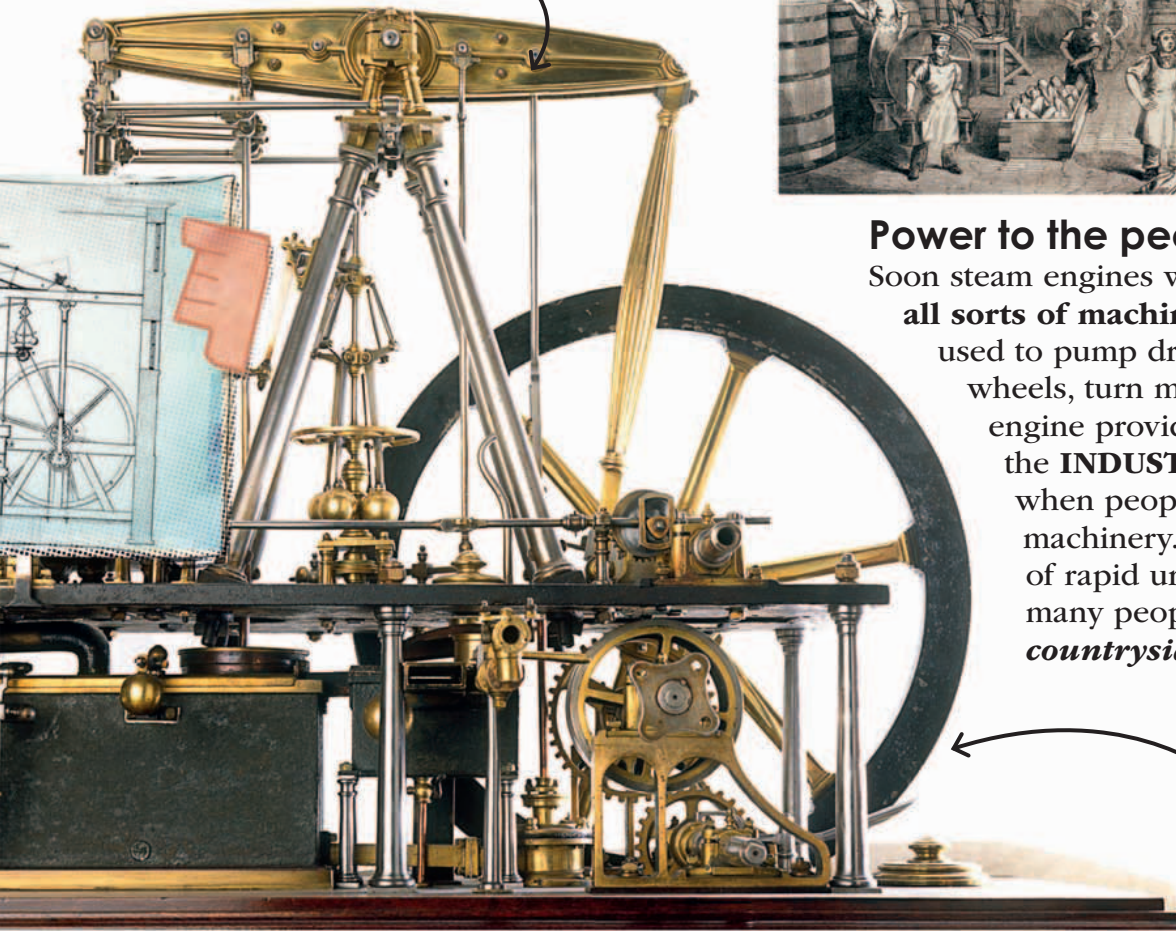


Steaming ahead

Up until Watt made his changes, the steam engine was used mainly to **pump water** from mines. Knowing that his new engine could be used for so much more, Watt took on a business partner called Matthew Boulton (1728–1829) to help market it. With Boulton's help, **IT WAS A GREAT SUCCESS**, and, by 1783, it had almost completely replaced the old Newcomen model.

Watt's engine began the shift of people's reliance on animal labor to machinery.



Watt on Earth

Watt's engine designs were the driving force behind decades of social and economic change that are still being felt today. However, apart from the steam engine, Watt also invented the process of manufacturing chlorine on a large scale, for use in bleaching.



Power to the people

Soon steam engines were being used to power **all sorts of machinery**. Watt's engines were used to pump drinking water, drive water wheels, turn mills, and drain docks. His engine provided the power that drove the **INDUSTRIAL REVOLUTION**, when people began to rely on machinery. This led to a period of rapid urban growth, and soon many people **abandoned the countryside** and moved into cities.

Watt came up with the term "horsepower" to explain how much work his steam engines could do.



In 1884, English engineer **CHARLES PARSONS** (1854–1931) developed the first steam turbine. Ten years later, the first steam turbine-powered ship, the **TURBINIA** was built.



Steam turbines are at the heart of every modern-day **POWER PLANT**. The turbines are used to convert the steam power into electricity.